

Joseph Benjamin O. Sollestre

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OBJECTIVE STATEMENT

Cybersecurity-focused Computer Science graduate pursuing a career in purple teaming and AI/ML Security. Experienced in building end-to-end security systems, from a self-hosted CTF competition platform with hardened authentication architecture to developing an ML-based vulnerability classification system. Active competitive CTF player with a top-40 all-time country ranking on TryHackMe, international-level competition experience, and hands-on experience solving modern cybersecurity challenges involving web exploitation, blue and red team operations, network analysis, and AI/LLM security and prompt injection.

SKILLS

Offensive Security: Penetration Testing, Kali Linux, Vulnerability Assessment, Web Application Security Testing, Authentication & Access Control Testing, Input Validation Testing, Nmap, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nikto, Gobuster, and Python.

Defensive Security & Forensics: Digital Forensics, Threat Hunting, Log Analysis, Network Traffic Analysis, and Incident Response Fundamentals using Wireshark, Autopsy, Volatility, Sysmon, and SIEM technologies.

Application Security: JWT and Authentication Security, Authorization Testing, XSS Testing & Remediation, Race Condition Analysis, Secure Coding, and OWASP-based security assessment.

AI/ML Security: ML-Based Vulnerability Classification, Security Data Analysis, Feature Engineering, Model Development, Python, Scikit-learn

Systems & Development: Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, JavaScript, Docker, Linux, Git/GitHub, Networking, TCP/IP, REST APIs, and Remote Access Administration.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- TRON 2026 Qualifiers Champion, representing 10th Infantry; currently competing in the TRON 2026 National Championships.
- Top 40 all-time country ranking on TryHackMe, with a top-country ranking achieved in May across blue team, web exploitation, and prompt-injection CTF rooms.
- Top scorer, CyLab Security Academy formerly PicoCTF platform.
- Built DeadNet, a full-stack self-hosted CTF competition platform (React/Vite/FastAPI/PostgreSQL/Redis).
- Developed SVAT (Security Vulnerability Assessment Tool), a CatBoost ML pipeline classifying cybersecurity risk of inactive Philippine SUC student portals - 94.44% accuracy, 0.9392 macro F1.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer & Penetration Tester

Sabinex — Service Provider Startup | Aug 2025 – Present

Full-Stack Development

- Develop and maintain client websites and web applications using Python and modern web technologies.
- Build and integrate frontend interfaces, backend services, databases, APIs, and application features.
- Contribute to application development, testing, deployment, and maintenance.

Security Testing

- Conduct authorized penetration testing and vulnerability assessments of web applications and portals.
- Test authentication, authorization, access controls, input validation, and application security controls for potential weaknesses.
- Perform reconnaissance, vulnerability discovery, validation, and security testing using Kali Linux, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, and Nmap.
- Analyze findings, assess security impact, and provide remediation recommendations to improve application security.

SELECTED PROJECTS

DeadNet - Self-Hosted CTF Competition Platform (OJT Project)

- Built a full-stack, self-hosted CTF platform with a cyberpunk aesthetic as an alternative to CTFd/HackTheBox.
- Implemented a four-role auth hierarchy with JWT authentication, email verification, and password reset.
- Designed a Contract Board with rarity tiers/bounty decay and a live Redis-cached Bounty Board across a multi-organization architecture.
- Enforced server-side flag comparison and identified/fixed flag exposure, XSS, race condition, and JWT misconfiguration vulnerabilities.

Tech: React, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker Compose, Railway

SVAT - Security Vulnerability Assessment Tool (Thesis)

- Built a CatBoost ML pipeline classifying cybersecurity risk of inactive Philippine SUC student portals.
- Achieved 94.44% accuracy and 0.9392 macro F1 on classification results.
- Delivered a full-stack app to present findings, pairing a FastAPI backend with a React/TailwindCSS frontend.

Tech: Python 3.12, FastAPI, React 18, TailwindCSS, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker

COMPETITIONS & SKILL BUILDING

- TRON 2026 Qualifiers Champion representing the 10th Infantry to compete in TRON 2026 National Championships.
- CyLab Security Academy - top scorer.
- TryHackMe - top 40 all-time country ranking; top-country ranking in May across blue team, web exploitation, and prompt-injection CTF challenges.
- 2024 Hack4Gov CALABARZON – 1st Runner Up.
- 2024 ASEAN CTF for Member States - Country Representative
- 2024 Trend University Capture the Flag - University Representative.
- 2023 12th IT Skills Olympics - University Representative.

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAININGS

- TryHackMe - Pre Security, May 7, 2026
- TryHackMe - Cyber Security 101, May 18, 2026
- TryHackMe – AI Security, July 2026 - Present

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Major in Intelligent Systems

Laguna State Polytechnic University - Siniloan | Oct 2021 – June 2026

REFERENCES

Available upon request.